

RDA Publisher Guidelines

Depositing RDA outputs using the RDA Publisher

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1. Introduction

The [RDA Publisher](#) is an **RDA Knowledge Base** (RDA-KB; figure 1)¹ application that assists with the publication of RDA resources (outputs, supplementary materials, or any other resource).

The Publisher prepares materials for automated deposit to **Zenodo** together with extended RDA-related metadata. Zenodo is an open and flexible repository for research papers, datasets, software, and other materials. The RDA Publisher also links resources to the **RDA Graph** database, which can be navigated using the search and discovery tools of the [RDA Discovery](#) interface.

In short, users enter metadata and upload files related to their output to the Publisher, which can be submitted directly to Zenodo for approval by an RDA Community manager.

1.1 What can you publish and where?

Any RDA group outputs can be published. Recommendations and Supporting Outputs have to go through the RDA's [internal endorsement process](#) before they can be published. Once the RDA Secretariat has approved the output for publication, the workflow for publishing these outputs on Zenodo is as follows:

1. **Publish to RDA group page:** The output is first submitted by WG/IG by co-chairs to their outputs page, by clicking the **Add New** button in the group's Outputs page.

¹ For further details about the RDA Knowledge Base as a whole, see its documentation at DOI: [10.5281/zenodo.17737222](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.17737222)

The output then goes through the RDA endorsement process (does not apply to “Other outputs”; skip to step 3). See the [RDA submission guidelines](#) for details;

2. **Wait for endorsement:** Once a submission is endorsed and published in the RDA Outputs and Recommendations Catalogue together with a DOI minted by the RDA;
3. **Publish to Zenodo:** Users go to RDA KB to publish the output to via the [Publisher](#):
 - a. A co-chair downloads and fills in the [RDA cover page](#), saves it as PDF, and combines it with the output PDF into a single PDF for publication to Zenodo;
 - b. The co-chairs submit via the Publisher using all required metadata: see section 2 for details.
 - c. The RDA Secretariat reviews the submission in the relevant Zenodo Community, and provides feedback when necessary;

Once a publication is accepted to the RDA Zenodo community, the RDA Secretariat will change any pre-minted DOI to point to Zenodo rather than the RDA Group Outputs page.

All RDA endorsed outputs (Recommendations and Supporting Outputs) are required to be published in the Zenodo RDA Community. Other outputs can be published in the Zenodo RDA-Related Documents Community. See the [RDA webpage](#) for further details. (section 2.2.1).

1.2 Advantages

Using the Publisher has several advantages:

- **Ease of use:** using the Publisher streamlines the process of publishing materials, by making it easier and fill in relevant metadata,
- **Support for multiple metadata schemas:** the Publisher can accommodate multiple metadata schemas depending on the type of content.
- **Consistent use of vocabularies:** The publisher can link to any number of LOD-type vocabularies and registries to better contextualise resources. The use of controlled vocabularies facilitates the consistent use of metadata by RDA users, making it easier to find related resources.

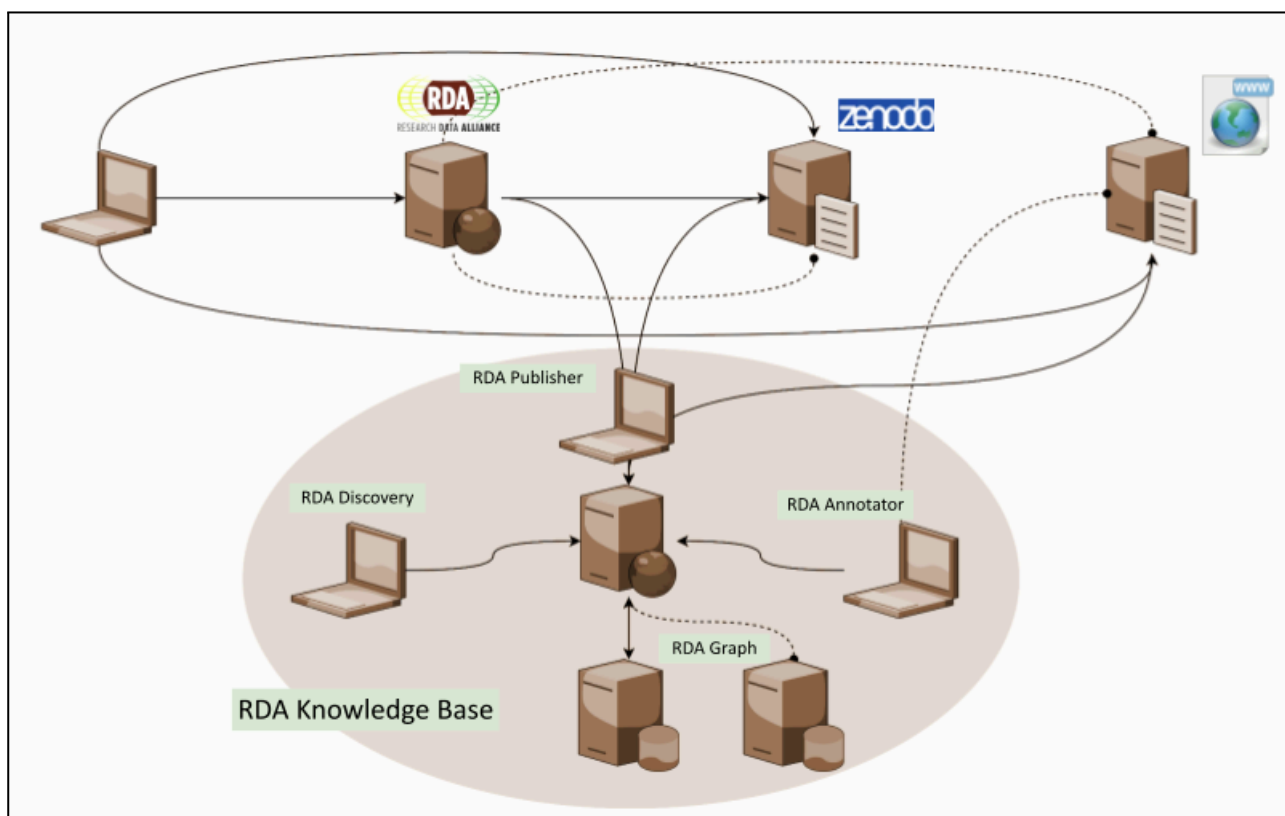


Figure 1: The RDA Knowledge Base, its components, and links to the RDA Website, Zenodo, and other web-based resources

2. Instructions

2.1 Accessing the RDA Publisher

The Publisher can be accessed under the [Publisher tab of the RDA-KB website](#) (see figure 6).²

To use the service, you first need to log in using your [ORCID](#) account. First-time users also have to do a one-time setup which links your ORCID account to the RDA Publisher, and to Zenodo, as well as linking Zenodo to the Publisher. This is described in detail below. **If you have already completed this process, skip to section 2.2.**

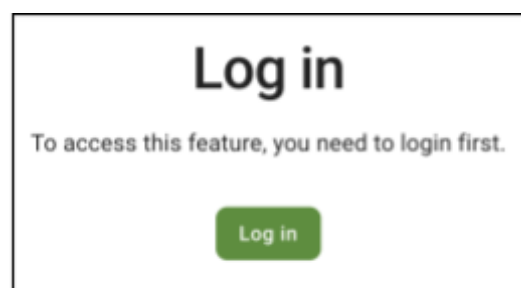


Figure 2: Publisher login prompt

² <https://kb-rda.org/publisher>

ORCID is a free and widely used persistent identifier (PID) for individuals in research, scholarship, and other activities. For instructions on how to register for free, see step 1 below. The use of authentication through ORCID allows users to save draft submissions, and overview submitted ones. It also streamlines the authentication necessary for submission to Zenodo, and allows RDA administrators to track submissions.

Setting up the Publisher for first-time use

Setting up the RDA Publisher can be done in minutes following the below steps:

1. **Set up ORCID** (if you already have one, skip to step 2): You can register a free ORCID account via orcid.org. You only need to provide your first & last name, email address, and employer (optional). You don't need to be associated with a university to sign up. See [ORCID's support page](#) for further details.
2. **Authorise the RDA Knowledge Base to access your ORCID ID:** This is necessary to authenticate using ORCID. The only information retrieved and used is your unique ORCID ID (e.g. 0000-0002-1145-0000).

The first time you log in to the RDA Publisher (figure 2), a prompt will appear requesting access to ORCID (figure 3). Simply click 'Authorise access' to accept. Access can be revoked or managed via your ORCID account's Trusted Parties menu.

3. **Create a [Zenodo](#) account** (if you already have one, skip to step 4): this is needed to obtain the Zenodo token in the next step. There are several ways to create an account (see [Zenodo's official instructions](#)), however perhaps the easiest way is to click "Sign up with ORCID" in the sign-up menu (top-right of the Zenodo website). Like in step 2, the first time you log into Zenodo using your ORCID ID, simply click 'Authorise access' in a prompt similar to that of figure 3.
4. **Add your personal Zenodo token to the RDA Publisher:** this is necessary in order to publish directly to Zenodo from the Publisher.

To obtain your personal token, log into Zenodo, and in the top-right menu under your login details, click 'Applications.' Click 'Create Token', select the 'deposit:actions' and 'deposit:write' scopes; give the token a name of your choice; and copy the resulting key (**do not share this key with others!**). See figures 4 for screenshots of this process.

Finally, log in via the RDA Publisher tab, click the user menu , click settings, and submit the token that you copied from Zenodo (see figure 5).



Authorize access

You are currently signed in as:



Simon Saldner
<https://orcid.org/0000-0002-1145-7829>
[Sign out](#)

RDA Knowledge Base

[Show details](#)

This organization has asked for the following access to your ORCID record:

 Get your ORCID iD

If authorized, this organization will have access to your ORCID record, as outlined above and described in further detail in [ORCID's privacy policy](#).

You can manage access permissions for this and other Trusted Organizations from within your list of [trusted parties](#).

Authorize access

[Deny access](#)

Figure 3: ORCID access prompt

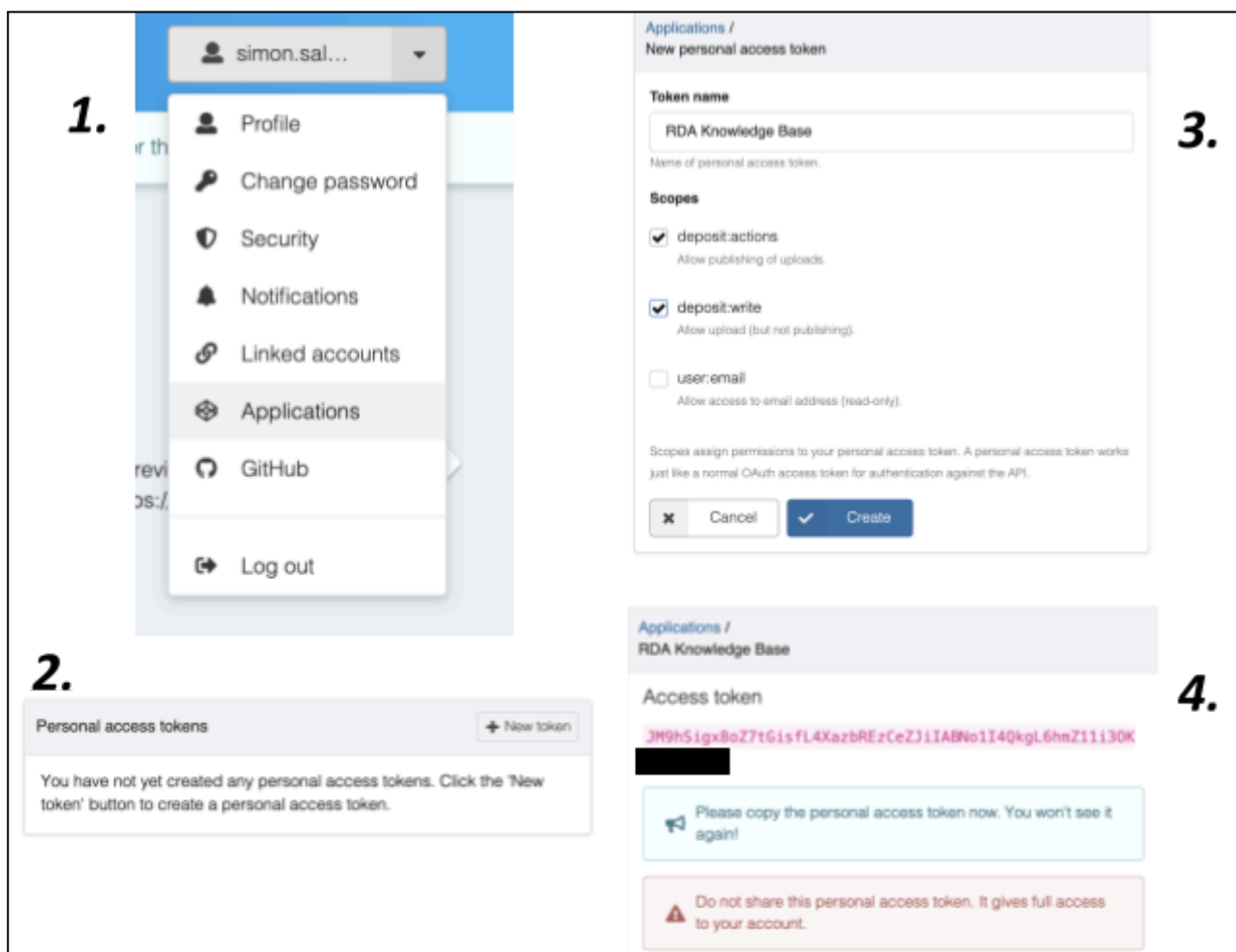


Figure 4. Creating a personal token in Zenodo

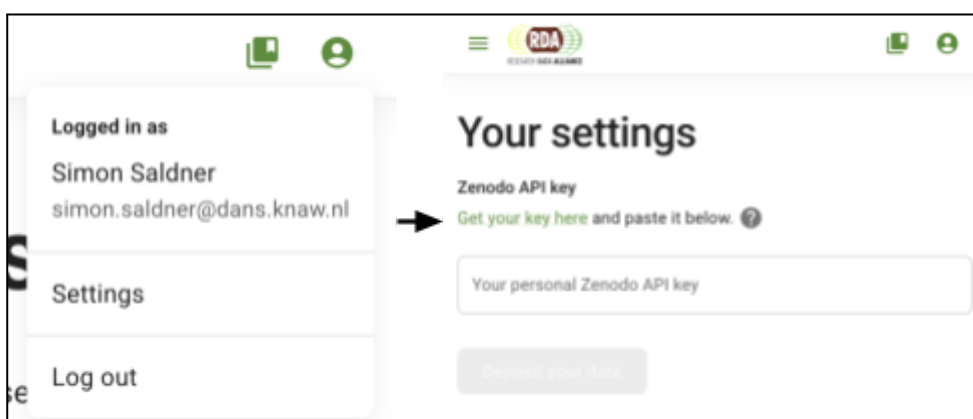


Figure 5. Adding your personal Zenodo token to the RDA Knowledge Base

2.2. Submission process

Once you have completed the one-time setup described in the previous section, and your output has been endorsed (see section 1.1), you are ready to submit a publication to Zenodo. First go to the RDA Publisher tab: kb-rda.org/publisher and log in to the interface (Figure 6).

This section will go through each step and section of the submission process. Each (sub)section of the Publisher is marked by one of three symbols below. Hover the mouse pointer over the symbol for more information about the particular field:

- ✓ = All required information has been provided
- ! = Provide required information before submission
- i = Recommended information not provided

The sections and metadata fields used by the RDA Publisher largely correspond to the fields used by Zenodo. Additional, RDA-specific metadata fields are added to e.g. Zenodo's 'Keywords and subjects' field.

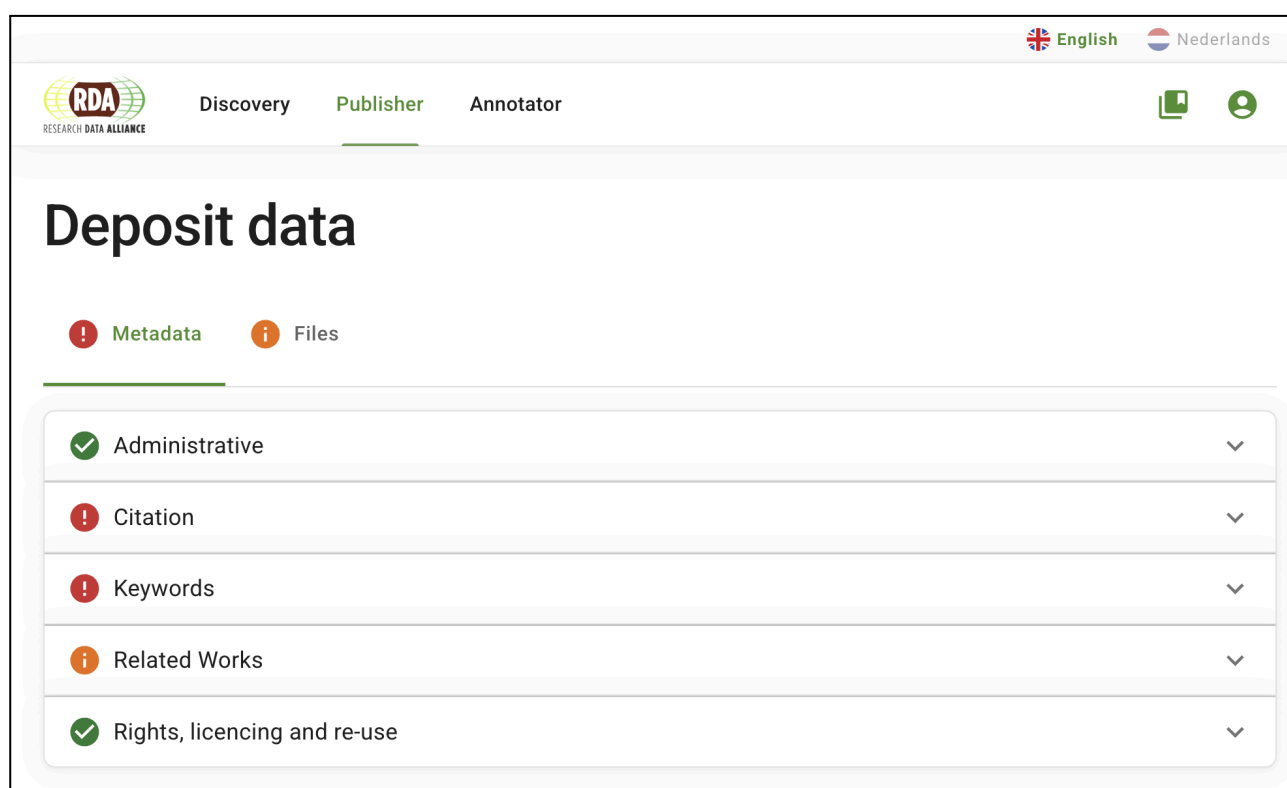


Figure 6. RDA Publisher interface

2.2.1 Metadata section

Administrative

This section is largely pre-filled, and consists of the following metadata fields:

Field	Description	
Depositor	Pre-filled with the name linked to the ORCID account used when logging in	!
Created	Date of creation of the deposit (not necessarily the same as ‘Publication date’)	!
Language	Language of the deposit	!
Zenodo Community	Zenodo communities are spaces where projects and institutions can curate and manage their inputs. In the case of the RDA, submitted outputs first need to be reviewed and approved before they appear in their Zenodo communities. Select one of the two Zenodo Community collections currently used by RDA:³ 1. Research Data Alliance, used for official documents that have been approved by the Governance Board, including: Governance documents, Recommendations, and Supporting Outputs 2. Research Data Alliance – Related Documents: Contains documents related to the RDA that are not official RDA documents, including: • Reports and other documents from RDA Working or Interest Group, or Community of Practices, Birds of a Feather (BoFs) that are not meant to be official group outputs; • documents from RDA-related activities, such as RDA national groups or initiatives, or; • RDA related events and workshop outputs.	!
Existing DOI (digital object identifier)	Provide the DOI minted for the output by the RDA (visible in the RDA group page output section). “Other outputs” are not RDA endorsed and do not receive DOIs. You can obtain a DOI yourself, or leave the field blank to let the RDA Secretariat mint it for you.	i

³ Not that a 3rd [RDA TIGER](#) community is currently also selectable. This is only intended for outputs related to this project.

Citation

Authors, publication type and other bibliographical information.

Field	Description	
Title	Title of the publication	!
Publisher	The publisher of the deposit. By default, 'Zenodo,' for RDA outputs, unless otherwise specified.	!
Version	Publication version. Semantic versioning is recommended (e.g. 1.0.0)	i
Publication date	dd-mm-yyyy	!
Description	Some context on the publication.	!
Author 1	Author for this deposit. Every submission requires at least one author to be specified. Additional contributors can be added in the Contributors section below. (Looks up data from ORCID as you type.)	!
Publication Type	The type of resource being deposited	!

Additional authors, contributors and RDA group name

Add additional authors, contributors, or RDA working groups. Working groups can be added as contributors with the 'Research Group' type.

Contributor	Contributor name (type to look up ORCID)	i
Contributor type	E.g. 2nd to Nth author, contributors, project leaders, or 'Research Groups' such as WGs	i

Keywords

Keywords, including from RDA-specific vocabularies. These fields allow multiple choices to be selected. Any values entered will be found under the Keywords field of the Zenodo publication.

Field	Description	
Primary Domains	Select the primary scientific domains relevant to this deposit	!
Pathways	Select relevant RDA pathways	
GORC Elements & Features	GORC International Model v1.1 Elements and Features. See: https://zenodo.org/records/14062994	i
UN SDGs	UN Sustainable Development Goals	i
Additional Keyword	Additional keywords of your choice that are not available in the other fields. Press the + sign to add more	i

Related works

Here, you can specify how the deposit relates to other works published on Zenodo or elsewhere. These fields correspond to the vocabularies used by Zenodo. For details, refer to [DataCite's overview](#) for a description of each relation type. Click  Add another to add more relations (each related work uses all three of the fields).

Field	Description	
Primary Domains	Select the primary scientific domains relevant to this deposit	i
Relation	Identifier of the related work (DOI, URL, etc.). Use DOI format 10.5281/zenodo.178670XX	i
Resource Type	Type of the related work resource	i

Rights holders

Here, you specify the organisation(s) or individual(s) owning the work, including licence conditions. By default, works published by RDA Groups use the values that are prefilled in this section (see below), but other values can be specified if necessary. Click  [Add another](#) to add multiple rights holders.

Field	Description	
Type	Whether the rights holder is a person or an organisation (default)	
Rights holders	The owner of the work (default: Research Data Alliance).	
Access type	The access types that apply to this deposit (default: Open).	
Licence	The licence type used (default: CC-BY-4.0)	

2.2.2 Files section

Here you add the documents, data, and other files you want to deposit. Zenodo allows 100 files and a total volume of 50 GB by default (see [Zenodo's documentation](#)).

See the “**Preferred Formats**” guidelines in the Knowledge Base Supports Materials Drawer (“Support” in the bottom-right corner of [kb-rda.org](#)) for recommendations about which formats to use for documents, photos and other files.

It is recommended to check the files carefully before uploading, as making changes after the files are published can be difficult. Zenodo allows minor revisions to uploaded files [within 30 days](#) of creating the record. Afterwards, you need to either create a new version of the deposit, or make a special request to Zenodo, as described in the previous link.

2.2.3 Saved and submitted forms

At any point of drafting a deposit, you can save your progress using the “Save” button at the bottom of the page. You can then access them in the Saved and Submitted Forms page, found under the  icon in the top-right corner of the page (provided you are logged in). **It is recommended that you save your progress regularly to avoid the risk of losing your work.**

On the Saved and Submitted Forms page, you can view saved and submitted forms. Saved forms can be edited using the  icon, deleted using the  button, or copied for a new submission using the  icon. The latter can be useful if you are submitting multiple deposits that use similar metadata.

Once submitted, deposits can be viewed () , or copied, and their submission status will be displayed, including any errors in the submission process.

2.2.4 Submission

Once all required information has been provided, you can submit the record by clicking “Submit Data” at the bottom of the screen. If all goes well, a green confirmation message will appear. Users are recommended to check submitted forms for their status, following the instructions in the previous section.

Once a record has been submitted, it must be approved by the administrator of the Zenodo community in question before it becomes available on Zenodo. This usually only takes a few working days.

The administrator may reach out to you with questions before approving the submission. Depending on the settings in Zenodo, you may be alerted of this via email, but it is recommended to log into Zenodo and check for messages about the status a few days following submission.

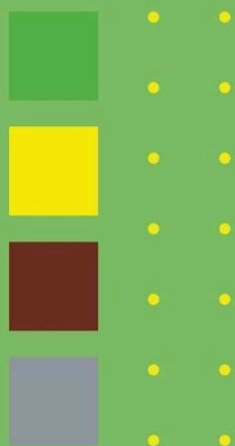
3. Troubleshooting and further information

Below you can find answers to some common issues encountered by users of the RDA Publisher. If you need further assistance, please contact our **Helpdesk** using the “Help” button at the bottom right of the kb-rda.org website.

For other questions related to the RDA Publisher, as well as other RDA Knowledge Base applications, see our [FAQs](#) in the (“Support” in the bottom-right corner of kb-rda.org). Here in the **Support Materials Drawer**, you can also find other useful information, including recommendations on how to make your publications FAIR and Accessible.

Common errors/issues

- Error: “Failed to send metadata to the server - 401.”
 - This error may appear after the RDA Publisher page with your draft has been left idle for a while. Refreshing the page should resolve the issue. Remember to save your progress regularly (see section 2.2.3) to avoid losing your work.
- Error: “Zenodo Prod Environment”
 - A technical error occurred either on the side of the RDA Knowledge Base, or at Zenodo. Please contact the Helpdesk as instructed above to receive assistance.
- I cannot click the “Submit Data” button.
 - This is most likely because all required fields have not been filled in. Look for any fields marked by  and enter some data. If this does not work, try refreshing the page.



research data sharing without barriers

rd-alliance.org